



IIT PALAKKAD



4th EDITION
AUG, 2021

FOOTPRINTS

ALUMNI CELL

CONTENTS

Institute Updates	
<u>Accomplishments</u>	1
<u>Institute Updates</u>	2
<u>Events</u>	3
Epigram	4
Student Activities	
<u>SAC</u>	8
<u>Alumini Cell</u>	9
<u>Akshar</u>	9
<u>Automotive Club</u>	9
<u>Finance Club</u>	10
<u>Shutterbug</u>	10
<u>YACC</u>	10
<u>Chess Club</u>	10
<u>MESA</u>	11
<u>Quiz Club Formation</u>	11
<u>Petrichor</u>	11
Footprints Interview	
<u>A peek into the personality of Mr. Iqbal</u>	12
A Thank You Note	17

ACCOMPLISHMENTS

- Roshan Mathews, a student in Electrical Engineering department won the first prize in the Undergraduate Research and Innovation Awards 2021. The second prize was bagged by a team consisting of Divyansh Khare (ME), Sushil Kumar (ME), Abhinav Kumar (ME), Gautham G Kumar (ME), Arjun K Vikram (ME), and Sandra Mary Jacob (EE).
- Ms. Sneha Bhattacharjee, a student of batch 2020 received a special mention in Technuctus, tech fest of IIT Jammu.
- Ms. Gayathri M, a Ph.D. student under Dr. Mahesh Panicker was one of the 10 finalists of the 3 minute Ph.D. thesis competition in IEEE's flagship conference in medical imaging - IEEE ISBI 2021.
- Ms. Sakila, a research scholar in Civil Engineering department working under Dr. Subhasis Mitra, received the best presentation award for the paper entitled 'Post processing short to medium range GEFS precipitation forecast in India' in HYDRO2020 International Conference organized by NIT Rourkela from 26-28 March 2021.
- Five students : Aniket Singh Rajpoot, Ayush Meena, Gourav Nishad, Manas Sharma and Mayank Katore from batch 2018 participated in the tech fest of IIIT Vadodara, "Cerebro" and secured third position in Counter Strike Global Offensive (CSGO) tournament.
- Dr. Mahesh R Panicker's project titled "Automated Covid-19 Lung Ultrasound (LUS) Analysis" became one of the thirty five projects to be featured on the Government of India's COVID portal selected from across the country.
- Mr. Shidhin Tom, a M.Tech student in the department of Mechanical Engineering, under the guidance of Dr. S. Kanmani Subbu and Dr. Samarjeet Chanda received the best presenter award for the paper entitled 'Effect of Laser Scanning Strategy on Residual Stress in Selective Laser Melting' in the Heat transfer session on iCRAFT2020 organised by BITS Pilani Dubai Campus from March 19-21, 2021. This paper will be published in AIP conference proceedings.

INSTITUTE UPDATES

Dedicated recording facility at Nila Campus

Speaking of Webinars, now IITPKD has a room dedicated to recording talks! Room 304 in the Samgatha building at the Nila campus has been specially designed with sound proofing and exceptional camera facilities. As of now, talks where green boards or light boards are used can be recorded. A Wacom tablet-based system is also expected soon.

IEEE Power and Energy Society Student Branch Chapter

Another example of IITPKD's growing presence in the technological industry is the formation of IEEE PES Student Branch Chapter. The Power & Energy Society (PES) provides the world's largest forum for sharing the latest technological developments in the electric power industry. This development will significantly increase students' reach into the international arena for working on energy projects and obtaining funding for the same. It will help them gain a much wider exposure to the happenings of this field. This will also improve professional awareness.

Stress Awareness Month

It is quite obvious why May had turned out to be the most important month of this year... but the SWCC and MITRA teams were prepared. They reached out to the students with essential tips, suggestions and supportive messages. They also arranged for an awareness session, where activities and workbooks, relating to stress management, were provided. The root causes were identified, myths were busted and remedies were spelled out. All in all, the staff have certainly outdone themselves, and have proven to be an invaluable asset for the students. They have been playing an active role along with the teachers in addressing the stress the students were having during the pandemic.

EVENTS

Women's Day 2021

Women's Day at IITPKD was celebrated with even more gusto than ever despite the pandemic. The women's forum at IITPKD, Kadambini, along with the SWCC and several others extended their wishes to everyone. The SWCC collaborated with Kadambini to organize a session on the topic "Women, Work, and Health". The session hosted women dignitaries like Dr. Rakhee E.P., assistant professor at Ahalia Ayurveda Medical College who had insightful talks and interactions with the students.

A Webinar on "Women in Leadership: Achieving an equal future in a COVID-19 world" was organized by the women Vice Chancellors and Principals of Colleges. The Education Minister, Mr. Ramesh Pokhriyal and Minister of State for Education, Mr. Sanjay Dhotre graced the occasion and addressed the gathering.

Epigrams

The most memorable moments of your B.Tech Life.

"It was Hitchhiking. I don't really recall the date. It was a random day when we decided to get some drinks from outside, jumped into a shuttle back to Palakkad and got stranded somewhere on the highway between Coimbatore and Palakkad. I definitely thought we would have to sleep on the road, as we waited near the road, biting onto steamy dosa from a roadside dhaba , waiting for any truck driver to stop. Finally, we got into a truck that was delivering sponge for footwear. Surprisingly, the driver was my neighbour from my hometown. He dropped us near the road to college. It was late anyway so we thought we would have to pay the late entry fine, so to escape the fine we tried to jump over a wall but got chased by dogs. Finally, we figured out some way around the hostel, did some jugaad and reached the hostel in one piece."

If you get a chance to take one person with you back to the hostel who would it be?

"A friend I met through the Internet. But it won't be relatable to anyone else who is reading it, so I'd say one of my juniors, Navaneeth MN."

What is one thing you wanted to do in your B.Tech life but couldn't do?

"I wish I'd been a bit more notorious perhaps."

If you were in charge of planning a concert for the college, which two artists/speakers would you bring?

"If I could bring anyone dead or alive then,
 Artists - Nirvana, Metallica, Tool, Porcupine tree, still corners
 Speakers - Terrance mckenna."



Vismay Raj

Alumnus, B'16, CSE

The most memorable moments of your B.Tech Life.

“The moment I was elected as an Acad Sec. I always wanted to do something more than studies. I wanted to do something for the institute and interact with more people and being the Acad Sec helped as a starting point.”

If you get a chance to take one person with you back to the hostel who would it be?

“Not a single person but the gangs with which we used to sit in front of hostels both in Ahalia and Nila which also included our Seniors. The wheel chair ramp in front of Hostel B has a special place in my heart.”

What is one thing you wanted to do in your B.Tech life but couldn't do?

“Always wanted to sing and dance on stage. Tried singing in my first year but it didn't work. Dance abhi bhi baaki hai.... :)”

If you were in charge of planning a concert for the college, which two artists/speakers would you bring?

“Would have been “SPB” who is no more. But when we have some talented people like Ashwin, Gayatri, Benhar, why do we look somewhere else.”



Venkata Sai Prasad
Bogudameedi

Alumnus, B'16, EE

The most memorable moments of your B.Tech Life.

“Hostel life, intra college sports meets, inter IIT camps, inter IIT meets, bonding among various batches during the inter IIT meets, valuable time spent with seniors, time spent as sports secretary, leading IIT Palakkad contingent during the opening ceremony march pasts, working on my project with Prof. Mehta, interacting with the faculty, especially faculty of the mechanical department.”

If you get a chance to take one person with you back to the hostel who would it be?

“It will be Patrick George of my batch. We met during the first day of registration and became friends because both of us were from TN. I have spent the most time with him in the hostels, mess, canteens, restaurants etc. We introduced each other to different sports, anime, series, movies etc and actually liked what the other guy suggested. So yeah, he was my go to guy during my college life even though we were from different departments and we still stay in touch regularly to this day.”

What is one thing you wanted to do in your B.Tech life but couldn't do?

“I was looking forward to the graduation ceremony with my batch mates which would have been a good culmination to the journey that I was a part of with all of them, but it is not possible now because I will be leaving for the US, hence killing any chance of attending the proposed graduation in September.”

If you were in charge of planning a concert for the college, which two artists/speakers would you bring?

“Assuming there isn't any budget constraint, I would like to have a Coldplay concert for the institute, with Ricky Gervais and Steve Carell opening with an act or a comedy routine. But more realistically I would like to open with stand up comedy by Rahul Subramanian and then a concert by Thaikkudam Bridge as I enjoyed their show during Petrichor.”



Arjun Thangaraj R

Alumnus, B'16, ME

The most memorable moments of your B.Tech Life.

"All the birthdays that I celebrated, Making Piyush feel horrified, multiple times during the 4 years, Pranking Gopal when he was in the washroom by enacting the way Biju Sir speaks, Sledging the coach and players of IIT Jodhpur in InterIIT Sports Meet and winning a match against them, Leading the protest against the attendance system of our college and getting successful results for the same, Being voted as the best Secretary of my batch, Many more....."

If you get a chance to take one person with you back to the hostel who would it be?

"There are many, but I will take Utsav with me back to the Hostel."

What is one thing you wanted to do in your B.Tech life but couldn't do?

"I wanted to give a speech or go on stage to reduce my fear of representing the crowd. I still think that I need to improve that thing and overcome my fear."

If you were in charge of planning a concert for the college, which two artists/speakers would you bring?

"I will invite two of my favourites. One is Diljit Dosanjh (Punjabi Singer, dancer & actor) and second is Major Vivek Jacob (Para SF commando of Indian Army)."



Abhishek Bagri

Alumnus, B'16, CE

STUDENT ACTIVITIES:

SAC:

Running Form on The Health Status of Students

The Second wave of COVID-19 pandemic adversely affected many of us, whether medically, financially, academically or psychologically. To reach the affected students and their families, in order to know their current status and help them out, on 5th May, 2021, the SAC, circulated a running form regarding the Health Status of Everyone. The form was required to be filled by every student, and almost all the students did the needful. The Status of all the students was shared in a spreadsheet and students whose friends' status was unknown, were asked to fill the form on their behalf after contacting them personally.

The SAC then contacted the afflicted students, and provided them with the requisite help. Many of the afflicted students who were not in a sound financial situation, were provided financial support. For the same, a donation drive was started in which many came forward and donated as per their capacity.

Virtual Music Concert Series

Music has a healing touch and during this stressful time when the whole world is suffering from the Covid-19 Pandemic, we all need a stress-buster. To relieve the stress of students, the SAC organized a series of live music shows, in collaboration with Ombre. The shows organized on this platform by the SAC were free within the college community and the revenue generated from the shows was donated to the SAC in their COVID Relief Fund.

They conducted four live concerts by the following artists

1. Manas Arora
2. Aakansha Devgan
3. Kaushal Brothers
4. Kairavi Rane

ALUMNI CELL

Logo Design Competition:

A logo designing competition for the Alumni Cell of IIT Palakkad was conducted in the month of March. The aim was to develop a logo which embraces the vision and significance of the Alumni Cell of IIT Palakkad, at the same time being eye-catching and creative. The prize money of ₹ 2000 and credit for the design was announced for the winner. Dr. LNT and Mr. Samuel judged the design entries submitted by the participants and declared Shivam Chauhan of 2019 Batch the winner of the logo design competition. Meaning of the logo: “The logo is a hexagonal hive representing IIT Palakkad as one cohesive organization made of three "palms" each one representing the alumni, students, and faculties/staff. The logo symbolizes the role of the Alumni Cell as an organization that forges a strong connection and relation between all these three bodies.” A special mention of Priyanka G R of 2018 Batch was made for her efforts.



CLUB ACTIVITIES:

AKSHAR :

The details of the competition conducted by Akshar are as follows:

ESSAY WRITING COMPETITION:

The essay writing competition was held to commemorate the supreme sacrifice of various unsung freedom fighters on the occasion of 164 years of martyrdom of Mangal Pandey, who is remembered as an emblematic figure for initiating the first war of Indian independence. The topic of this competition was 'A tale of any unsung freedom fighter and their role in the freedom struggle'. The winners of the competition were as follows:

First position: Shreya M P, Batch 2019 ([Link to the writeup](#))

Second position: Gunja Thanmayee, Batch 2020 ([Link to the writeup](#))

AUTOMOTIVE CLUB :

The automotive club held a unique competition named mobility design competition which asks students to design their future concept car with the notion that it tries to solve a real world problem. The winners of this competition were as follow:

First position: Makireddy Antharya, Batch 2019

Second position: Paul Tony, Batch 2019

The automotive club also organised an interactive session with Team Pravega from Government Engineering College Barton Hill. Team Pravega had won the circular economy award for The Shell Eco Marathon Asia 2020, one of the world's leading student engineering competitions. Poster of the session can be found on the next page:

The Automotive club organized a four day long Engine Bootcamp session held on four different dates in February and March 2021. The aim of the bootcamp was to teach students the functioning and components of automobiles from basic to advanced level. The sessions were taught by Dr. Anand T.N.C.

FINANCE CLUB:

The Finance club held an innovative business model competition. The competition was an innovative business competition to support and showcase innovative solutions in the field of plastic waste management. Competitors taking part in the challenge were asked to submit a business model which tackles the issues of Plastic waste management. The winners of this competition were as follow:

First position: Dilip Kalyani, Batch 2018

Second position: Suchitra Yechuri, Batch 2018

SHUTTERBUG:

Shutterbug Photo Editing Contest -VGC

The photography club held a photo editing contest as part of the virtual general championship. Students were asked to show their editing skills on the samples provided by the club. The winners of this competition were as follows:

First position: Jayanth Kumar , Batch 2019

Second position: Vivek, Batch 2019

Third position: Jayanth Kumar , Batch 2019

YACC System Design Session:

On 10 April 2021, YACC organised a system design session for one hour that covered the basic concepts of System Design. A demo project was done, thereby discussing the design and architectural concepts of the same. The contents discussed that day were intro to SD, high low level design, server to client, peer to peer, web meet application, project demo followed by a discussion and a questionnaire.

CHESS CLUB:

Weekend chess tournaments - Chess club of IIT palakkad made it possible for students to be a part of weekly intra IIT blitz chess tournaments.

MESA:

Ansys sessions - Mechanical Engineering Students Association of IIT Palakkad conducted tutorial sessions to familiarise the students with Ansys, an important simulation software for engineers.

QUIZ CLUB FORMATION:

A quiz club for IIT palakkad was formed to improve the quizzing culture of our institute. Earlier this fell into the jurisdiction of akshar, the literary club, but now it was formed as an independent body. Paul Tony of batch 2019 was appointed as the head.

PETRICHOR:

Petrichor formed a new team to organize the fest for the coming year. Arjun V, from batch 2019 was selected as the fest coordinator. Along with him, the core team was selected for Petrichor '22

A peek into the personality of Mohammed Iqbal

Overview

Mohammed Iqbal is a student from the 2015 batch of IIT Palakkad. Known for his friendly and approachable personality he served as the first cultural secretary of the newly formed SAC and also as the Ideate head for the first edition of Petrithor, the techno cultural fest of IIT Palakkad. An avid cinematographer and director of a few short films Iqbal is currently pursuing MTech from IIT Madras.



How are you doing? We know you love to ride,so how did you handle the lockdown?

I'm doing a Master's at IIT Madras but currently staying at home attending online classes. I love to ride and it is one of my hobbies. Even though I'm pretty busy, with so many deadlines, projects, and assignments, I don't fail to find time to go for a ride whenever there is a relaxation of lockdown or so. It relaxes my mind. Riding helps me to get rid of all the stresses in my work and be relaxed and happy.

How did you find out that you were interested in filmmaking ? What aspect of filmmaking interests you? ..Is it just a hobby or do you consider pursuing it as a career choice? If yes, Any attempts to work with people in the cine field ?

I was in the first batch of IIT Palakkad and joined the college in 2015. I hadn't done anything related to dramatics or acting before my college. It's college life, so there is no one to tell you that you cannot do this or that, and it was my opportunity to experiment with things. There was a talk among students about making a Ramayan drama on Diwali. A team was made with my friends who knew the story and we started practicing. The play turned out to be great, and people liked and appreciated it. So I got into dramatics first. But then later, I thought, I could do something bigger if I had a chance. That is if I could control some things. For example, there is no retake in a drama and you have to manage the costumes, the stage and everything. There were limitations on what could be done on a stage. I mean, I had to put everything towards the play. It's very difficult. Film-making overcomes these problems and gives time and opportunity to make one scene better and more connected to the audience and that's why I chose to start making one short film in the year 2017.

In 2016-17, I was the Cultural Secretary. I couldn't develop my skills in film making because I was busy with making clubs, Onam celebrations, etc. After my tenure as the Cultural Secretary, I thought of making a short film and I also planned with this team for almost one month. That's how I moved to short filmmaking and that's how I started making the first short film. It was great. Everything was in our hands. We can modify however we want it or how that scene should go in front of the audience. Cinematography is the main thing. Like you can see a scene from different angles and there are infinite possibilities. But you have to select one frame from these infinite possibilities and that frame should be the best and I find that interesting.

I like that cinematography part more than the direction which is hectic and creative work. Director is the head of it while a cinematographer decorates his work.

Filmmaking and photography is just a hobby right now, like when I am stressed I take my camera, get some clicks of food or something, and edit it myself. Also, I recently did a socially relevant short film citing how online shopping is affecting small retailers. I don't want to choose it as a profession but rather would like to have a balance between my profession and my hobby. I find it quite interesting and I will spend time on it if I find any engaging concepts. The creative side always helps and it balances my mind.



You are doing a masters at IITM. How did you decide your path of engineering? What next?

After my B.tech, I was not sure. I just wanted to get a job because money was my priority. And fortunately, I didn't get any good placement. I said fortunately because I didn't know what I was doing then. I just wanted to get a job and that's not what we should do. I mean, we should take a profession that is matching our interests.

I took a year break after my Btech. During my BTech life, I didn't give much importance to academics. But we should always find a proper balance between academics and co-curricular activities. I realized this in my break and I used this break to understand the concepts and what engineering is. So I decided to do my master's and wrote the Gate exam. Masters would help me gain the proper knowledge and I felt that I should do it. I am not speaking for everyone but I felt that I should do my masters if I had to be more creative and more into engineering. And my current plan is to go for a PhD. Iqbal in the third or fourth year of B.Tech would have just laughed at this :). I'm doing my masters in ocean structures. My research interest is in offshore wind turbines and I plan to go for a PhD. I've never really decided. I don't know how this thing is gonna change my life and I don't believe in my plan. Actually, like I already have a plan, but I will end up somewhere else. But what we should do is hard work and be honest and sincere.

You should always focus on what you want to do and not care about the salary and all because finally you're going to spend a lot of years in this field till you die or age, so it should be the appropriate thing to do.

Tell us about your experience as a Cultural secretary? How was your experience Taking part in the Cultural tech meet ? What are some of the things you learnt from your experience seeing other older IIT students performing with cultural meet that our cultural clubs also learn from?

Initially, when the college started in 2015, there were no clubs. The election for the cultural secretary happened in my second semester and in the first semester, we performed a drama. And we unofficially formed a drama club in the first semester and performed a drama.. It was the only club that was active. When I became the cultural secretary, in my second semester I felt I had a huge responsibility to start from nothing. My first step was to implement clubs as much as possible and then start working on it. Even while forming the drama club, the effort came first, and then the team, that is we had a few performances and found the urge to have a club for dramatics to make things happen. So I wanted to do the same thing for everything else. So as Cultural Secretary, I just organized many programmes and then formed clubs. In the second year, we had Independence Day celebrations, Onam, Freshers, Republic day celebrations, and all organized and conducted. We tried to showcase maximum performance whether it be dance, drama, music or any other thing. There was a need to show that we were doing something to the institute and the audience as we would require funds for the clubs, like instruments for music clubs ,etc. That's when we started these clubs. In my tenure, I just wanted to do the basic things, which was to form as many clubs as possible and show the institute that we have enough students and materials with us with creative minds. That we can do these things apart from our academics.

The next Cultural secretary organised for Inter IIT and that was in 2018. The main thing was that we had very little manpower. We had students who performed for both drama and dance clubs. We had to check their availability and had to do a lot of planning just for them. Other IITs had a large crew along with much technical help. We had to write the script and make the scene parallel as we didn't have much time. We didn't have a spare and the students were also performing for other competitions and it was packed. After all that we had to edit and I sat for 10 hours straight. Even though a new institute, we had access to a good camera and it would have been easier if we had enough members. Even with what we had on those days, we were in 11th position out of the 23 entries and I believe this was a great achievement for the team as well.

You were the first batch to graduate from IIT Palakkad. What were your best and worst memories/experiences? How did IIT life prepare you as a person, for your subsequent chapters in life?

The first thing is we had a temporary campus and initially we didn't have WiFi for the first two months which actually has an advantage because we all got interconnected so much and so easily.

We used to come out and just talk to each other, and we used to speak about personal experiences like how we are managing these things and concerns with filmmaking, Petrichor, cultural events and all. IIT Palakkad really taught me time management. I got experience from managing both academic deadlines and cultural deadlines. I understood the importance of time management. And then the other thing that I have learned is that hard work pays off for sure. That is how much hard work we do, that much result will be obtained. There is no short cut to success. We always need to work hard. I should say IIT Palakkad has taught me a lot of things in life.

You were decoration and videography head of Petrichor. What were your experiences and what is your opinion on our college fest PETRICHOR!! Are there any moments that you want to share with us?

We started with 7 core members. It started from nothing and we have to build from nothing, which is really difficult or maybe it was a really good place to learn and start things. I was in marketing in the beginning and even in other events. Later I was in the decoration and videography head. We started to prepare for the event and 1 week before the fest was very hectic and we worked so hard to make the events successful. But those days are very sweet memories now.



Petrichor started from the stage where faculty said no, to a stage where it's actually a fest now. It's probably more than what we thought it would be. We felt it as a pitch where we have done experiments. If you want to do something, just do it even if the risk is high. If it fails, it's ok but you will learn a lot and you will have that experience, but feel responsible for what you are doing and give your best and finally you will be happy and satisfied with your work. But I guess that if you give it a try, once you fail, that fear is gone. Like you, you are free to experiment. If you're sure that you want to do something, just go for it. Don't think about the consequences. I enjoyed a lot in these 4 years like literally everything. If you just wanted to make a resume, to get a job, then college life will be very small. When I hear the name of it, I recollect a lot. It is the place where you gain experience and make a lot of memories. I have enjoyed being a part of all these things and I find my happiness in these things.

What motivates you to get out of bed or prevents you from going to sleep? What do you think is important in life and why?

Deadlines!! It is the main thing which drives me. Nowadays, When I sit in front of a laptop studying, at some point I will lose interest and control. But if we want to complete something we have to set up a deadline then only we can achieve it.

Tell us 2 things you would like to tell 2 people (preferably 1 directed to a person in your batch and 1 directed to a person currently at IIT Palakkad or batch-2016). You do not have to tell us whom it is directed towards. Preferably in first-person. (you are more than welcome to say more)

My batch: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=fXUP3LZbjK0>

Current batch': Make petrichor the best fest in India.

What would you suggest our current batches of how to find the right path? Wisdom you would like to pass on to us ?

I would suggest that maintaining a proper balance between academics and co-curricular activities and planning is very important which I learnt from my experience. It will help a lot in your life. If you want to do something just do it and don't watch TV series.

A THANK YOU NOTE

A team is not merely a group of people working together. With the cooperation, determination, and dedication among its members, it can be an entity that does tasks deemed difficult and creates lasting impressions. The former Alumni Cell team has shown us what a team could be.

It is the dedication and determination of you all that resulted in the successful formation of the Alumni Cell and your hard work that brought it to its current zeal. You have not only motivated the future teams but also set the standard for us to adhere to in continuing the journey.

With lots of positive feedback from everyone, we would like to extend our appreciation for the amazing work you've done. We are obliged to each one of the core team members including Anand Kumar Sharma, Balaji Sai Kumar Bandura (Database Manager), Maria Rose Joseph (Communication Officer), Mitul Kataria (Web Team Head), Muskaan Maheshwari (Event Manager), Putluri Yogitha Reddy (Communication Officer), Shrujan Kanabar (Media Coordinator), Ashini Najeena Jaleel (Editor-in – Chief), Gunjan (Creative Content Head), Rajath R (Design Team Head) for their amount of extensive work done, their resilience and the legacy they are leaving behind